Commas & Apostrophes (Set B)

Year 4 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. We packed shorts, shirts, socks and sandals.
2. I won't go without my coat.
3. C) The bowl had apples, pears and grapes.
4. Tom's bike.
5. Possession — shows the whiskers belong to the cat.
6. Contraction — short for 'cannot'.
7. A) don't; C) can't; D) it's
8. Please pass the salt, Grandad.
9. B) The dog's bone was buried.
10. the class's homework (one class) — or 'the pupils'' homework' if treating as many pupils; accepted answer: the class's homework.
11. The recipe needs flour, sugar, butter and eggs.
12. C) teachers'
13. Any correct sentence using 'they're' correctly, e.g. 'They're coming to the party.'
14. 'The boy's bag' means one boy owns the bag; 'the boys' bag' means more than one boy owns it (shared).
15. A) Come here, Priya.; D) Thank you, Sam, for your help.

Green — Building Fluency

16. Although it was cold, Maya refused to wear a coat.
17. A comma is needed to separate the fronted subordinate clause from the main clause, showing where the first idea ends.
18. C) Later that evening, the storm arrived.
19. the cats' collars.
20. Because 'children' is already an irregular plural (not ending in -s), the possessive is formed by adding 's, just like a singular noun.
21. A) My uncle, who lives in Spain, is visiting.; E) The dog, a small terrier, barked all night.
22. It's been raining since this morning, so bring an umbrella.
23. C) We saw lions, tigers and bears at the zoo.
24. James's opinions.
25. 'Your' shows possession, e.g. 'Is this your book?' 'You're' is short for 'you are', e.g. 'You're late.'
26. Yes, Miss Patel, I have finished my essay.
27. C) Jack and Jill's house was large.
28. It was a long, cold, tiring journey.
29. Because the apostrophe after the s already shows the plural possessive ('women's' — but note 'women' is already plural so needs 's, not s'); adding a second apostrophe after the final s is incorrect and non-standard.
30. A) The rain stopped, and the sun came out.; D) I wanted to stay, but I had to leave.

Red — Challenge

31. the dog's bone = belongs to one dog; the dogs' bone = belongs to more than one dog
32. The two teams' captain gave a talk.

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33. My neighbour, who moved here last year, is friendly.
34. A) The ladies' bags
35. The old bridge, which had stood for years, finally collapsed.
36. It's a shame the kitten's toy broke.
37. Whose scarf is this? It's very soft.
38. A) Let's go, Dad!
39. A) Teacher's staffroom
40. your = possessive (e.g. "Is this your bag?"); you're = you are (e.g. "You're late.")
41. A, B and E (the cat's, the cats' and the women's are all correctly punctuated for singular/plural possession; C wrongly adds an extra s, D should be "women's" since "women" is already plural)
42. Without warning, the alarm sounded.
43. knights' armour
44. A) It is a possessive pronoun, and possessive pronouns never take an apostrophe
45. fox's

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. We bought bread, milk, cheese and jam.
2. I haven't seen that film.
3. C) The bag held pens, pencils and rulers.
4. Aisha's scarf.
5. Possession — shows the nest belongs to the bird.
6. Contraction — short for 'did not'.
7. A) wasn't; C) haven't; D) she's
8. Please close the door, Aunty.
9. B) The cat's bowl was empty.
10. the team's lockers (one team) — accept 'the players'' lockers' if treating as many players.
11. The box contained books, pencils, rulers and crayons.
12. C) doctors'
13. Any correct sentence using 'you're' correctly, e.g. 'You're doing really well.'
14. 'The girl's coat' means one girl owns the coat; 'the girls' coat' means more than one girl owns it (shared).
15. A) Hello, Mr Khan.; D) Please help me, Omar.

Green — Building Fluency

16. Even though she was scared, Lily climbed the ladder.
17. A comma is needed to separate the fronted subordinate clause from the main clause.
18. C) Suddenly, without warning, the alarm sounded.
19. the dogs' leads.
20. Because 'men' is already an irregular plural (not ending in -s), the possessive is formed by adding 's, just like a singular noun.
21. A) My aunt, who lives in Leeds, is visiting.; E) The parrot, a noisy bird, squawked all day.
22. It's been snowing since last night, so wrap up warm.
23. C) We saw elephants, giraffes and zebras at the park.
24. Sara's opinion.
25. 'Whose' shows possession, e.g. 'Whose coat is this?' 'Who's' is short for 'who is' or 'who has', e.g. 'Who's coming?'
26. No, Mr Evans, I have not finished yet.
27. C) Ben and Lucy's project was excellent.
28. It was a bright, warm, cheerful morning.
29. Because the apostrophe is correctly placed after the plural 's' in 'babies'' to show more than one baby; adding an extra apostrophe after an already-correct possessive form is non-standard.
30. A) The bell rang, and the pupils left.; D) I was hungry, but I waited.

Standard / Advanced

31. "the class's trophy" — class is singular (one class), so the apostrophe goes before the s.
32. No — this is a plural decade, not a possessive, so no apostrophe is needed (1980s).
33. "my sisters' car" — sisters is plural (more than one owner), so the apostrophe goes after the s.
34. Yes — it goes before the s, as "the cat's bowl," because one cat owns it.
35. "Hers" is already a possessive pronoun, so it never takes an apostrophe, e.g. "That coat is hers."
36. My brother's best friend, whose name is Omar, is staying this weekend.

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37. The two cats' bowls were empty and the dog's bowl was full.

38. Sam's hat, scarf and gloves were soaked.

39. A — without commas, it means only some friends (those who live abroad) are visiting.

40. "It's the players' turn next," said the coach.

41. A, C and E (hers, it's and theirs are all correctly formed; B and D wrongly add apostrophes to possessive pronouns)

42. The moon's light lit up the garden and the owl's hoot echoed through the trees.

43. A) Because they are already possessive pronouns

44. C) teachers' staffroom

45. B) The boy's coat was muddy, so he couldn't wear it.

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